tech leaders

The AI Agent System

How to build AI agents that work with any model,
any tool, and the systems you already use

technical-leaders.com

AGENDA

What you'll leave with

1

A working agent skill of your own

Designed for a workflow you actually do, plugged into the tools you already use

2

A plan for what to do next

30 days of concrete steps to extend it

THE LEAP

From prompts to skills

PROMPT

One ask, one answer

- You write the question
- It returns text
- You copy, clean, paste
- You're still the glue

SKILL

A reusable role

- Knows what to take in and give back
- Plugs into a real tool
- Runs without you in the loop
- Reusable on new things you throw at it

If you have to copy-paste between AI conversations or retrain your AI chats, it's still a prompt.

STRUCTURAL

The anatomy of a workflow and an agent skill

A workflow is a series of tasks you do. A skill is something agents run to accomplish a task.

WORKFLOW

Sea of demand

- A — Define the problem space
- Ag — Find relevant communities
- Ag — Extract pain-point quotes
- M — Sanity-check top quotes
- Ag — Draft engagement strategy

SKILL

A skill is precise instructions how to do a step in a workflow. *Almost like a mini app or teammate role.*

ROLE	Customer intel specialist
GOAL	Find ICP pain points
INPUT	Problem space
WORKFLOW	5-step research protocol
OUTPUT	Communities + quotes
TOOL	Web → Document

Map the workflow. The skill runs it.

Turn on privacy mode

You're about to share real workflows with AI. Turn off training-data sharing first.

CLAUDE

Settings → Privacy

```
Help improve Claude
→ OFF
```

CHATGPT

Settings → Data Controls

```
Improve the model for everyone
→ OFF
```

30 seconds. Worth it.

BETTER REASONING

Upgrade how your AI thinks

Drop this into your AI's custom instructions. Better outputs across the board, no extra effort.

```
Use the Adaptive Reasoning Protocol:

Assess the request type, then apply the appropriate method.

If solving, analyzing, or debugging → Atom of Thought:
decompose into atomic units. State each one. Validate.
Verify. Then synthesize.

If explaining, learning, or teaching → Feynman Loop:
use a concrete analogy. Flag confusion points. Ask
questions that reveal gaps. Compress to a snapshot.

If both → chain them: solve, then explain.
```

Set once. Pays off every time AI works for you.

Reframe with “How might we…”

Open-ended questions invite more solutions. Use this to pick and frame your workflow.

STUCK

I spend too much time on email

→

REFRAMED

How might create a skill that helps manage my email?

STUCK

Research takes too long

→

REFRAMED

How might we create a skill to research prospects and create a meeting prep strategy?

STUCK

Reporting is a slog

→

REFRAMED

How might we create a skill to send weekly reports that help us grow?

Closed problems shut down thinking. Open questions open up options.

Discover your workflow

Pick the one weekly workflow that bleeds the most time. We'll turn it into a system.

WHAT YOU SHOULD HAVE

1. The workflow you want to automate
2. The 3–5 tools it touches today
3. The one tool to plug agents into
4. A real recent input — email, brief, lead, or task

STUCK? PASTE THIS PROMPT

```
How might we create a new skill that
helps me be the best world-class MY_ROLE
possible (like ELITE_EXAMPLES_OF_ROLES).
I'm planning to use you as my personal
executive assistant and MY_ROLE expert
to suggest the best strategic actions
for me to take each day.
```

Don't have it all? Use the prompt. We'll keep moving.

Manual, Assisted, or Agent?

Not every step should be an agent. Tag each one honestly.

M Manual

Judgment calls. Trust. Relationships.

EXAMPLES

Final pricing decision. Hiring choice.

A Assisted

You're in the loop. AI helps you do it.

EXAMPLES

Drafting a tough email. Reviewing a proposal.

Ag Agent

Repeats. Defined inputs. Predictable outputs.

EXAMPLES

Daily summaries. Lead enrichment. Reformatting.

What's inside a real agent skill

Sea-of-demand, the skill you're getting today, breaks its workflow into 7 tagged steps.

- **A** Define the problem space my product solves
- **Ag** Search 100+ sources for relevant communities
- **Ag** Extract raw pain-point quotes from each one
- **Ag** Score pain points by frequency × intensity
- **Ag** Decode the buyer language patterns
- **M** Sanity-check the top quotes for authenticity
- **Ag** Draft engagement strategy + summary

When you design your own skill in a few minutes, you'll think the same way.

Choose the right model for the job

We'll build in Claude. The same structure runs in any of these.

Claude

BEST FOR

Strongest general agent for most business use cases.

ChatGPT

BEST FOR

Consumer-friendly with Image gen built in.

Gemini

BEST FOR

Best at computer vision and image generation (Nanobanana).

Copilot

BEST FOR

Wired into the Microsoft stack.

What kinds of tools?

Your agents can plug into any of these. Pick where the work already lives.

Web browser

Fill out forms, click around, enter data on any site.

Calendar / Email / CRM

Read communications, see what you've delivered.

Docs / Notion

Give agents context — your processes, voice, materials.

Canva / Figma

Speed up design work in the tools you already use.

Pick the tool where you already work. That's where the agent should connect.

BUILD · YOUR EXAMPLE

Meet sea-of-demand

This is the working agent skill you're getting today. Use it as a model for your own.

THE SKILL

Sea-of-demand

Customer intelligence specialist that finds where your ICP is talking online and extracts what they're saying.

[download link in chat]

SEA-OF-DEMAND · REPORT

ICP signal map · founders selling AI services

Generated from 14 communities · 3,420 posts analyzed

01 · TOP COMMUNITIES

- r/Entrepreneur — 892k members · 47 posts · last 30d
- r/SaaS — 210k · 39 posts · last 30d
- Indie Hackers · Building — · 31 posts · last 30d
- r/sweatystartup — 104k · 22 posts · last 30d
- r/AgencyGrowth — 18k · 19 posts · last 30d
- LinkedIn · #FractionalCxO — · 37 posts · last 30d

02 · REAL PAIN QUOTES

> **"I keep buying courses but nothing actually compounds."**
> r/Entrepreneur · 142 upvotes

> **"Clients want results, not a 40-tool tech stack we built for them."**
> Indie Hackers · 89 comments

> **"We charge for outcomes now — hourly is a race to the bottom."**
> r/AgencyGrowth · 211 upvotes

> **"AI promised leverage. We just have more dashboards to ignore."**
> LinkedIn post · 1.2k reactions

Buyer language patterns · Engagement playbook · Channel-by-channel scripts

A complete, working agent skill. Yours to keep, copy, and learn from.

Watch sea-of-demand do its thing.

I'll run it on a real problem space, live. You'll see how a real agent skill behaves with input, workflow, output, all in one shot.

[screen share — sea-of-demand running]

Now design your own agent skill

Use this prompt to have AI design a brand-new skill that's perfect for your workflow, or use this PA prompt example:

```
How might we create a new skill system
that does TASK_OR_WORKFLOW_DESCRIPTION
using SYSTEMS_OR_TOOL_NAMES without
having to do MANUAL_WORK_DESCRIPTION
```

1. Replace TASK_OR_WORKFLOW_DESCRIPTION with what you want done
2. Replace SYSTEMS_OR_TOOL_NAMES with 2–3 names you'd want to learn from
3. Paste it. Iterate with the AI until your skill feels right.

```
How might we create a new skill
system that helps me be the best
world-class MY_ROLE possible
(like ELITE_EXAMPLES_OF_ROLES).
I'm planning to use you as my
personal executive assistant and
MY_ROLE expert to suggest the
best strategic actions for me to
take each day.
```

1. Replace MY_ROLE with what you do (founder, ops lead, AE, etc.)
2. Replace ELITE_EXAMPLES with 2–3 names you'd want to learn from
3. Paste it. Iterate with the AI until your skill feels right.

BUILD · YOUR TURN

YOUR TURN

5

MINUTES

Design your agent skill

- [ ] Paste the prompt with your MY_ROLE filled in
- [ ] Read what AI gives you back — does it match your work?
- [ ] Iterate: "more focused on X", "add a step for Y"
- [ ] Stop when the skill feels like a real teammate

Run it on the real input you brought

Now feed your new skill the real input you have to see what happens.

REAL INPUT

the email you brought

```
From: maria@craftbrew.co
Subject: feedback on our pitch
```

Hey — our distributors keep asking the same questions in calls. We've answered them 30+ times. Can we build something that does this without me on every call? Budget is small but we need traction this Q.

— Maria

YOUR SKILL

running on the input

```
$ skill: distributor-faq-agent

→ reading thread… done
→ extracting questions: 7
→ clustering by topic: 4
→ drafting FAQ doc
→ drafting outreach reply
 done in 23s

100%  ·  ready to review
```

RESULT

is it useful?

Distributor FAQ — v1

auto-drafted from 30 calls

- **Q1.** What's lead time on bulk orders?
- **Q2.** Do you offer co-op marketing dollars?
- **Q3.** What's the minimum reorder?
- **Q4.** Net 30 or net 60?

REPLY DRAFT

Hi Maria — attached is a draft FAQ covering the 7 questions distributors hit most. Want me to send it as a self-serve PDF?

Most skills will partially work on first run. That tells you where to fix.

YOUR TURN

5

MINUTES

Run your skill on real input

- [ ] Feed your real input into the skill
- [ ] Read the result out loud — would you ship it?
- [ ] Note the biggest gap. Don't fix it yet.
- [ ] If it's clearly wrong, iterate on the prompt once

Score your skill

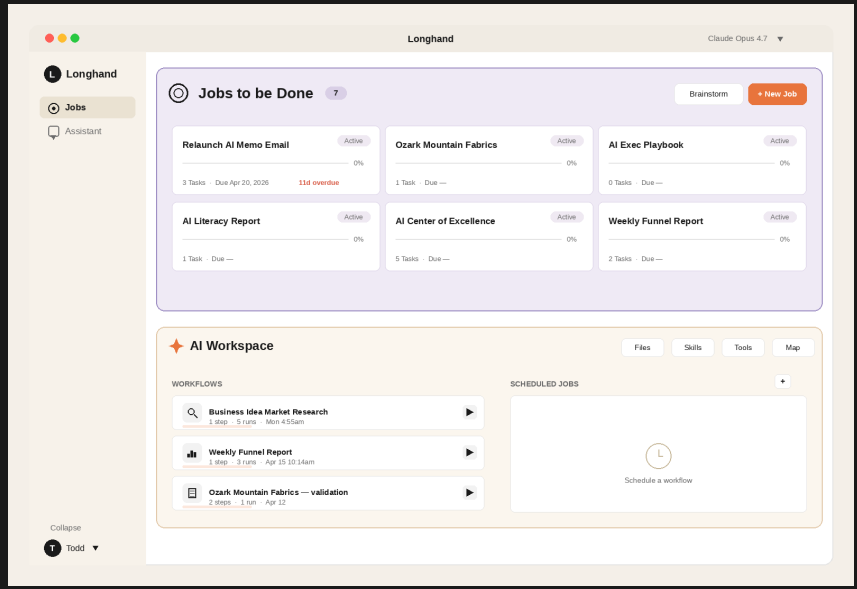
Honest scoring. Not pass/fail — just where it needs work.

1. Does the skill do the job you wanted it to?
2. Does it work on the real input you brought?
3. Is the output something you'd use today?
4. Would you send it to your toughest reviewer?

Your agent need a home.

Longhand runs agent skills on your real work. Any model. Any tool. All in one place.

- Routes between Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot
- Connects to the tools without code
- Schedules and triggers your agents automatically
- Private local models for regulated industries



Watch me import to Longhand

YOUR TURN

5

MINUTES

Deploy to Longhand

- [ ] Open Longhand (your access link is in chat)
- [ ] Import your SKILL.md file
- [ ] Connect your skill to your target tool
- [ ] Run it on a fresh input. Confirm it works.

Your 30-day plan

Today is day zero. Here's how the system gets to compound.

WEEK 1

Fix

Run it 3x. Fix the gap you saw today.

WEEK 2

Add

Add a second skill that takes what your first one makes.

WEEK 3

Connect

Wire a real tool integration in Longhand.

WEEK 4

Ship

Hand the skills to one teammate. Watch what breaks and then iterate on it to fix it.

Two ways to keep going with our help

AI CALL

AI Strategy Session

Talk through AI training and done-for-you agents for you and your org.

technical-leaders.com/ai-call

WEEKLY

Office Hours Membership

Get help every week from us and the community as you build your agents.

technical-leaders.com/ship-ai